

I wrote a cheat sheet for the reasons why using ChatGPT is not bad for the environment

Posted by u/MrMasley • 0 points • 1 comments

[Full post here](https://andymasley.substack.com/p/a-cheat-sheet-for-conversations-about). I divided it into sections based on common points that regularly come up in conversations. I'm not especially pro or anti AI more broadly, but I'm worried a lot of people are drastically misunderstanding the energy and water involved in ChatGPT prompts and it's distracting the climate movement. Here are all the sections:

* **[Personal use]**(https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/personal-use)

* [A ChatGPT prompt uses too much energy/water]
(https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/a-chatgpt-prompt-uses-too-much-energywater)

* [Energy](https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/energy)

* [Water](https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/water)

* [ChatGPT is bad relative to other things we do (it's ten times as bad as a Google search)]
(https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/chatgpt-is-bad-relative-to-other-things-we-do-its-ten-times-as-bad-as-a-google-search)

* [ChatGPT uses enough energy that you should be very careful with how you use it. Don't use it as a search engine or a calculator or just to goof around]
(https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/chatgpt-uses-enough-energy-that-you-should-be-very-careful-with-how-you-use-it-dont-use-it-as-a-search-engine-or-a-calculator-or-just-to-goof-around)

* **[Global use]**(https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/global-use)

* [Data centers are an environmental disaster. This shows that ChatGPT as a whole is using too much energy and we should boycott it]
(https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/data-centers-are-an-environmental-disaster-this-shows-that-chatgpt-as-a-whole-is-using-too-much-energy-and-we-should-boycott-it)

* [ChatGPT may not raise your own carbon footprint much, but it will be very bad for the environment if everyone starts using it]
(https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/chatgpt-may-not-raise-your-own-carbon-footprint-much-but-it-will-be-very-bad-for-the-environment-if-everyone-starts-using-it)

* [ChatGPT uses as much energy as 20,000 households]
(https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/chatgpt-uses-as-much-energy-as-households)

* [Training an AI model uses too much energy]
(<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/training-an-ai-model-uses-too-much-energy>)

* [****Other objections****](<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/other-objections>)

* [This is all a gimmick anyway. Why not just use Google? ChatGPT doesn't give better information](<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/this-is-all-a-gimmick-anyway-why-not-just-use-google-chatgpt-doesnt-give-better-information>)

* [Don't trust some random Substack post over scientific research]
(<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/dont-trust-some-random-substack-post-over-scientific-research>)

* [This post is "whataboutism." ChatGPT is still bad for the environment because it emits at all.](<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/this-post-is-whataboutism-chatgpt-is-still-bad-for-the-environment-because-it-emits-at-all>)

* [****Some other useful intuitions in conversations****]
(<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/some-other-useful-intuitions-in-conversations>)

* [AI companies don't want to give you free energy]
(<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/ai-companies-dont-want-to-give-you-free-energy>)

* [It's 3 Wh!!!!](<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/its-wh>)

* [We should be focused on systematic change over individual lifestyles]
(<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/we-should-be-focused-on-systematic-change-over-individual-lifestyles>)

Comments

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2025-04-30 15:10 UTC

Hey /u/MrMasley!

If your post is a screenshot of a ChatGPT conversation, please reply to this message with the [conversation link](<https://help.openai.com/en/articles/7925741-chatgpt-shared-links-faq>) or prompt.

If your post is a DALL-E 3 image post, please reply with the prompt used to make this image.

Consider joining our [public discord server](<https://discord.gg/hT6PXe8gdZ>)! We have free bots with GPT-4 (with vision), image generators, and more!

🤖

Note: For any ChatGPT-related concerns, email support@openai.com

I am a bot, and this action was performed automatically. Please [contact the moderators of this subreddit](/message/compose/?to=/r/ChatGPT) if you have any questions or concerns.